Sector consisted of one regiment (equivalent to an Indian brigade) deployed in the DBO and Galwan areas with the headquarters at Qizil Jilga in Aksai Chin. The Middle Sector comprising the Changchenmo Valley was looked after by another regiment with its headquarters some 130 kilometres north of Rudok and east of Lanak-la. In these two sectors, Chinese troops were to only handle the supporting arms, while Sinkiang Muslims or the Tibetans, as per the area allocated to them, would act as the assaulting troops. A third regiment with its headquarters at Rudok was deployed opposite the Pangong-Spanggur sector, its area of responsibility extending up to Chang-la. In this region, Chinese troops were to be used for the actual fighting. All three sectors came under the command of a divisional headquarters, based at Shahidulla in Sinkiang.

A smaller force under the Western Tibetan Command based in Gartok was stationed in Tashigang, to operate in the Demchok area if the need arose. The Demchok Sector was to be otherwise handled entirely by Tibetan troops.

The Chinese had an extremely efficient intelligence network and were fully aware of almost all Indian moves. Ironically, the Indians were not far behind. Apart from the IB which had its own network, IAF Canberra aircraft from 106 Squadron regularly made low-flying sorties, photographing all Chinese movement on the other side. In Tibet, the PLA simply did not have the means to intercept these aircraft which had a free run of the skies. Squadron Leader J. M. ‘Jaggi’ Nath, who first photographed the Aksai Chin highway sometime in mid-1959, claims that he would regularly take off from Agra, cross over into Chinese airspace near the Karakoram Pass, then head all the way to NEFA keeping the Great Himalayan Range to his right, before re-entering India along the Lohit Valley. ‘We regularly gave them (Air HQ) detailed photographs of Chinese deployment and movement. The Army Commander Western Command commended me, so where is the question of the top brass not knowing what was going on across the border.’

In 1961, 14 J&K Militia commanded by Lieutenant Colonel Nihal Singh had been given charge of the entire Nubra Valley and the DBO Sector. The battalion headquarters was initially situated at Thoise (Partapur) and its six wings (of approximately forty men each) were guarding the Indo-Sinkiang trade route. After the Kongka incident involving Karam Singh and his men, more importance was given to this sector and the